

Unit - 1

Q1.

Positive psychology differs from traditional psychology primarily because it:

- A. Focuses exclusively on happiness
- B. Rejects the study of mental illness
- C. Examines strengths and optimal functioning alongside pathology
- D. Ignores environmental influences

Correct Answer: C

Q2.

The “nature” of positive psychology is best described as:

- A. A preventive and growth-oriented scientific approach to human flourishing
- B. A philosophical rejection of scientific methods
- C. A therapeutic alternative to psychiatry
- D. A branch limited to clinical populations

Correct Answer: A

Q3.

Which of the following best represents the core dimensions of positive psychology?

- A. Intelligence, personality, aptitude
- B. Positive emotions, positive traits, positive institutions
- C. Cognition, affect, behaviour
- D. Motivation, perception, learning

Correct Answer: B

Q4.

A major aim of positive psychology is to:

- A. Replace abnormal psychology
- B. Eliminate negative emotions entirely
- C. Develop diagnostic systems for strengths disorders
- D. Enhance individual and collective well-being

Correct Answer: D

Q5.

Well-being in positive psychology is best conceptualised as:

- A. Temporary pleasure and excitement
- B. Absence of psychological distress
- C. A multidimensional state involving meaning, engagement, and relationships
- D. Economic prosperity alone

Correct Answer: C

Q6.

The shift from GDP to GNHI reflects recognition that:

- A. Economic growth guarantees happiness
- B. National development must incorporate psychological and social well-being
- C. Wealth distribution is irrelevant to life satisfaction
- D. Productivity is the sole measure of national success

Correct Answer: B

Q7.

Gross National Happiness Index (GNHI) differs from GDP because it:

- A. Measures only industrial production
- B. Ignores subjective well-being
- C. Focuses solely on cultural traditions
- D. Includes psychological, environmental, and social indicators

Correct Answer: D

Q8.

The holistic approach to human development emphasises:

- A. Exclusive focus on material progress
- B. Integration of physical, emotional, social, moral, and spiritual growth
- C. Genetic determinants of personality
- D. Competition as the primary human motive

Correct Answer: B

Q9.

Which perspective in positive psychology emphasises human potential and self-actualization?

- A. Humanistic perspective
- B. Behavioural perspective
- C. Psychoanalytic perspective
- D. Biological determinism

Correct Answer: A

Q10.

The PERMA model (though not limited to it) illustrates that well-being is:

- A. Purely subjective
- B. Based only on achievement
- C. Comprised of measurable psychological components
- D. Identical to life satisfaction

Correct Answer: C

(10 Marks)

Q1. Critically examine the concept and nature of Positive Psychology by discussing its dimensions, aims, and scope. Evaluate the shift from GDP to Gross National Happiness Index (GNHI) as a paradigm change in understanding development. In your answer, analyse the relevance of the holistic approach to human development and discuss how positive psychology addresses the contemporary value crisis.

Unit - 2

Q1.

The long-term value of self-control is best explained in terms of:

- A. Immediate emotional suppression
- B. Avoidance of social punishment
- C. Delayed gratification aligned with future goals
- D. Reduction of cognitive dissonance

Correct Answer: C

Q2.

Self-regulation differs from simple self-control because self-regulation:

- A. Involves goal monitoring, evaluation, and behavioural adjustment
- B. Focuses only on resisting impulses
- C. Is limited to emotional control
- D. Operates unconsciously

Correct Answer: A

Q3.

Which scenario best reflects effective personal goal setting?

- A. Setting vague but ambitious aspirations
- B. Choosing externally imposed goals to gain approval
- C. Setting specific, measurable, and intrinsically meaningful goals
- D. Avoiding difficult goals to reduce stress

Correct Answer: C

Q4.

Personal goals enhance well-being primarily when they:

- A. Are socially prestigious
- B. Align with intrinsic values and personal meaning
- C. Require high competition
- D. Minimize effort

Correct Answer: B

Q5.

Failure of self-control is most likely when:

- A. Cognitive resources are depleted after sustained effort
- B. Goals are clearly structured
- C. External monitoring is present
- D. Behaviour is intrinsically motivated

Correct Answer: A

Q6.

Ego depletion theory suggests that self-control:

- A. Is unaffected by prior exertion
- B. Strengthens automatically under stress
- C. Operates like a limited psychological resource
- D. Is purely biologically determined

Correct Answer: C

Q7.

Which factor most strongly connects personal goals with psychological well-being?

- A. External rewards
- B. Goal clarity and self-concordance
- C. Peer comparison
- D. Social pressure

Correct Answer: B

Q8.

When an individual repeatedly postpones important tasks despite long-term intentions, this most directly reflects:

- A. Effective emotional regulation
- B. Goal substitution
- C. Self-actualization conflict
- D. Impulse dominance over executive control

Correct Answer: D

Q9.

The ability to adjust strategies when progress toward a goal is blocked demonstrates:

- A. Behavioural rigidity
- B. Emotional suppression
- C. Adaptive self-regulation
- D. Motivational withdrawal

Correct Answer: C

Q10.

Chronic self-control failure is most likely to negatively impact well-being through:

- A. Increased intrinsic motivation
- B. Strengthened identity formation
- C. Enhanced resilience
- D. Accumulated stress and reduced self-efficacy

Correct Answer: D

(10 Marks)

Q1. Critically examine the role of self-control and self-regulation in personal goal setting and psychological well-being. Discuss the psychological mechanisms underlying self-control failure and evaluate how individuals can strengthen self-regulatory capacity in academic and professional contexts.

Unit - 3

Q1.

In trait psychology, a “trait” is best defined as:

- A. A relatively stable and enduring disposition that influences behaviour across situations
- B. A temporary emotional state shaped by environmental triggers
- C. A moral quality developed solely through social conditioning
- D. An unconscious conflict rooted in early childhood

Correct Answer: A

Q2.

Which assumption most strongly differentiates trait theories from psychoanalytic theories?

- A. Behaviour is determined by unconscious sexual drives
- B. Personality consists of measurable and relatively stable characteristics
- C. Development is fixed by psychosexual stages
- D. Human behaviour is largely irrational and conflict-driven

Correct Answer: B

Q3.

Cattell’s contribution to trait theory is most accurately described as:

- A. Classifying traits into central and secondary traits
- B. Developing the lexical hypothesis of personality
- C. Identifying 16 primary personality factors through factor analysis
- D. Proposing five global personality dimensions

Correct Answer: C

Q4.

Allport distinguished between cardinal, central, and secondary traits. A “cardinal trait” is:

- A. A dominant characteristic that defines a person’s entire life
- B. A temporary behavioural tendency
- C. A biologically inherited reflex
- D. A socially constructed role.

Correct Answer: A

Q5.

The Big Five model demonstrates that positive traits such as gratitude and resilience are most closely associated with:

- A. High neuroticism
- B. High openness and conscientiousness
- C. Low agreeableness
- D. High psychoticism

Correct Answer: B

Q6.

Personal strengths in positive psychology are best conceptualized as:

- A. Defensive mechanisms that reduce anxiety
- B. Situational behaviours shaped by reinforcement
- C. Stable capacities that enable individuals to thrive and function optimally
- D. Cultural norms imposed by society

Correct Answer: C

Q7.

Forgiveness, as a positive trait, primarily involves:

- A. Denial of harm caused
- B. Suppression of anger without emotional change
- C. Forgetting the offense entirely
- D. Replacing resentment with prosocial motivation

Correct Answer: D

Q8.

Gratitude contributes to psychological well-being primarily because it:

- A. Encourages rumination about past mistakes
- B. Shifts cognitive focus toward positive experiences and social bonds
- C. Eliminates all negative emotions
- D. Promotes dependency on others

Correct Answer: B

Q9.

Positive belief systems (e.g., optimism) influence behaviour mainly by:

- A. Altering expectations about future outcomes
- B. Ignoring environmental constraints
- C. Increasing avoidance coping
- D. Repressing anxiety unconsciously

Correct Answer: A

Q10.

Which of the following best illustrates the interaction between trait theory and positive psychology?

- A. Viewing forgiveness as a situational defence mechanism
- B. Treating gratitude as a fluctuating emotional state only
- C. Understanding strengths as enduring dispositions that promote adaptive functioning
- D. Interpreting optimism as unconscious wish fulfilment

Correct Answer: C

Section B:

Q1. (10 Marks)

Define “trait” and critically examine major trait theories of personality (Allport, Cattell, and the Big Five). Further analyse how personal strengths, forgiveness, gratitude, and positive belief systems function as positive traits contributing to psychological well-being and adaptive behaviour. Integrate theoretical explanation with applied examples.

UNIT - 4

1.

Resilience in psychology is best conceptualized as:

- A. A fixed personality trait determined genetically
- B. A dynamic process involving adaptation to adversity
- C. A temporary emotional response to stress
- D. A defense mechanism against trauma

Answer: B

2.

Which perspective emphasizes that resilience develops through life experiences across stages of development?

- A. Ecological perspective
- B. Stress-adaptation model
- C. Developmental perspective
- D. Positive psychology perspective

Answer: C

3.

From an ecological perspective, resilience is primarily influenced by:

- A. Biological predispositions
- B. Environmental and social systems
- C. Cognitive distortions
- D. Individual coping styles only

Answer: B

4.

The stress-adaptation model of resilience focuses on:

- A. Personality traits as predictors of resilience
- B. Cultural determinants of coping
- C. Emotional intelligence as a fixed ability
- D. Adaptation through coping mechanisms and regulation

Answer: D

5.

Which of the following is NOT a characteristic of resilient individuals?

- A. Emotional regulation
- B. Cognitive flexibility
- C. Avoidance of challenges
- D. Strong social connections

Answer: C

6.

Self-efficacy contributes to resilience by:

- A. Eliminating stressors
- B. Enhancing belief in one's ability to manage challenges
- C. Reducing emotional awareness
- D. Promoting dependence on others

Answer: B

7.

Which of the following is considered an external source of resilience?

- A. Intrinsic motivation
- B. Emotional intelligence
- C. Social support networks
- D. Cognitive flexibility

Answer: C

8.

Cognitive restructuring in resilience-building refers to:

- A. Avoiding negative experiences
- B. Suppressing emotions
- C. Reframing negative thoughts into constructive perspectives
- D. Ignoring stressful situations

Answer: C

9.

Spirituality is best defined as:

- A. Strict adherence to religious doctrines
- B. A scientific approach to mental health

- C. A social institution regulating morality
- D. A personal search for meaning and connection beyond the self

Answer: D

10.

Which of the following best distinguishes spirituality from religion?

- A. Spirituality is always collective, religion is individual
- B. Religion lacks ethical frameworks
- C. Spirituality can exist outside formal religious systems
- D. Religion focuses only on nature

Answer: D

Subjective Questions

1.

Critically examine the major theoretical perspectives on resilience (developmental, ecological, positive psychology, and stress-adaptation models). How do these frameworks complement each other in explaining adaptive functioning under adversity?

2.

Discuss the role of spirituality in enhancing psychological resilience and well-being. Evaluate its functions as a coping mechanism, moral framework, and source of meaning in contemporary life.

UNIT - 5

1. Which of the following best reflects the role of genetics in happiness?

- A. Happiness is entirely environmentally determined
- B. Genetics establishes a baseline level of happiness
- C. Happiness is solely determined by cognitive patterns
- D. Genetic influence disappears after adulthood

Answer: B

2. Neurotransmitters such as dopamine and serotonin primarily influence happiness through:

- A. Social bonding mechanisms only
- B. Cognitive appraisal processes
- C. Mood regulation and pleasure experience
- D. Cultural adaptation

Answer: C

3. Which psychological factor is most strongly associated with sustained happiness?

- A. Material wealth accumulation
- B. External validation
- C. Sense of purpose and meaning
- D. Avoidance of stress

Answer: C

4. The practice of gratitude contributes to happiness by:

- A. Increasing dependency on others
- B. Reinforcing negative cognitive biases
- C. Enhancing focus on present deficiencies
- D. Promoting positive cognitive appraisal

Answer: D

5. Which of the following best explains the diminishing impact of income on happiness?

- A. Income reduces motivation
- B. Basic needs satisfaction plateaus its effect
- C. Wealth eliminates emotional experiences
- D. Social relationships become irrelevant

Answer: B

6. In collectivist cultures, happiness is more likely to be derived from:
- A. Individual achievement
 - B. Personal autonomy
 - C. Social relationships and community bonds
 - D. Economic competition

Answer: C

7. The Experience Sampling Method (ESM) is primarily used to:
- A. Measure long-term life satisfaction
 - B. Assess genetic predisposition to happiness
 - C. Capture real-time fluctuations in emotional states
 - D. Evaluate economic indicators

Answer: C

8. Which of the following is an example of an objective indicator of happiness?
- A. Self-reported life satisfaction
 - B. Emotional introspection
 - C. Gratitude journaling
 - D. GDP per capita

Answer: D

9. The Positive and Negative Affect Schedule (PANAS) measures:
- A. Cognitive intelligence
 - B. Personality traits
 - C. Emotional experiences across time
 - D. Economic well-being

Answer: C

10. Which statement best reflects the relationship between physical health and happiness?
- A. Physical health is unrelated to happiness
 - B. Happiness is purely psychological
 - C. Physical health indirectly influences happiness through biological processes
 - D. Happiness determines genetics

Answer: A

Subjective Questions

1.

Critically evaluate the multidimensional determinants of happiness, including biological, psychological, social, and environmental factors. How do these domains interact to produce subjective well-being?

2.

Discuss the major methods of measuring happiness (self-report, experience sampling, objective, and biological measures). Evaluate their strengths, limitations, and implications for psychological research.

UNIT - 6

MCQs (10 Questions)

1. According to existential and positive psychology perspectives, the primary human motivation is:

- A. Pursuit of pleasure
- B. Search for meaning
- C. Avoidance of pain
- D. Social dominance

Answer: B

2. Which theorist emphasized that meaning enables individuals to endure suffering?

- A. Albert Bandura
- B. Viktor Frankl
- C. B.F. Skinner
- D. Jean Piaget

Answer: B

3. Logotherapy is primarily concerned with:

- A. Behavioral conditioning
- B. Cognitive restructuring
- C. The pursuit of meaning in life
- D. Emotional suppression

Answer: C

4. Which of the following is NOT a major source of meaning in life?

- A. Relationships
- B. Work and achievement
- C. Random pleasure-seeking
- D. Contribution to society

Answer: C

5. The relationship between meaning and resilience can be best explained through:

- A. Emotional suppression
- B. Cognitive reframing of adversity
- C. Avoidance coping
- D. Behavioral extinction

Answer: B

6. Optimists typically interpret negative events as:

- A. Permanent and internal
- B. Global and uncontrollable
- C. Temporary and specific
- D. Irreversible failures

Answer: C

7. Which of the following best distinguishes optimism from pessimism?

- A. Biological vs social origins
- B. Emotional vs cognitive processes
- C. Differences in explanatory style
- D. Presence vs absence of stress

Answer: C

8. Biophilia refers to:

- A. Fear of natural environments
- B. Cognitive detachment from nature

- C. Innate human affinity toward nature
- D. Social dependence on ecosystems

Answer: C

9. Ecopsychology suggests that:
- A. Nature has no psychological relevance
 - B. Mental health is independent of environment
 - C. Psychological well-being is linked to connection with nature
 - D. Only urban environments promote resilience

Answer: C

10. Nature contributes to resilience primarily by:
- A. Eliminating stress entirely
 - B. Increasing material resources
 - C. Providing distraction from reality
 - D. Offering grounding and perspective

Answer: D

Subjective Questions

1.

Critically examine the role of meaning in life as a central construct in positive psychology. How does it contribute to resilience, coping, and long-term psychological well-being?

2.

Discuss the interrelationship between optimism, resilience, and nature. How do these constructs collectively contribute to adaptive functioning in the face of adversity?